

Team Healthy Family

II PUC · Ch 3 · Reproductive Health

Starring Bindu 👧 & Prof. BAIO 🦉

A BAIO storybook by Narendra Sir · Biology Lecturer



What Is Reproductive Health?

"According to the WHO, **reproductive health** means total well-being — physical, emotional, behavioural and social," said Prof. BAIO. "India was one of the first countries to start family planning, in 1951. Today it is called **RCH** — Reproductive and Child Health care."

💡 **REMEMBER**

A statutory ban on amniocentesis for sex determination protects the girl child.



Natural Methods

Some couples avoid pregnancy naturally. **Periodic abstinence** means avoiding coitus from day 10 to 17 of the cycle. **Lactational amenorrhea** works because ovulation stops during intense breastfeeding — but only up to six months after delivery.

💡 **REMEMBER**

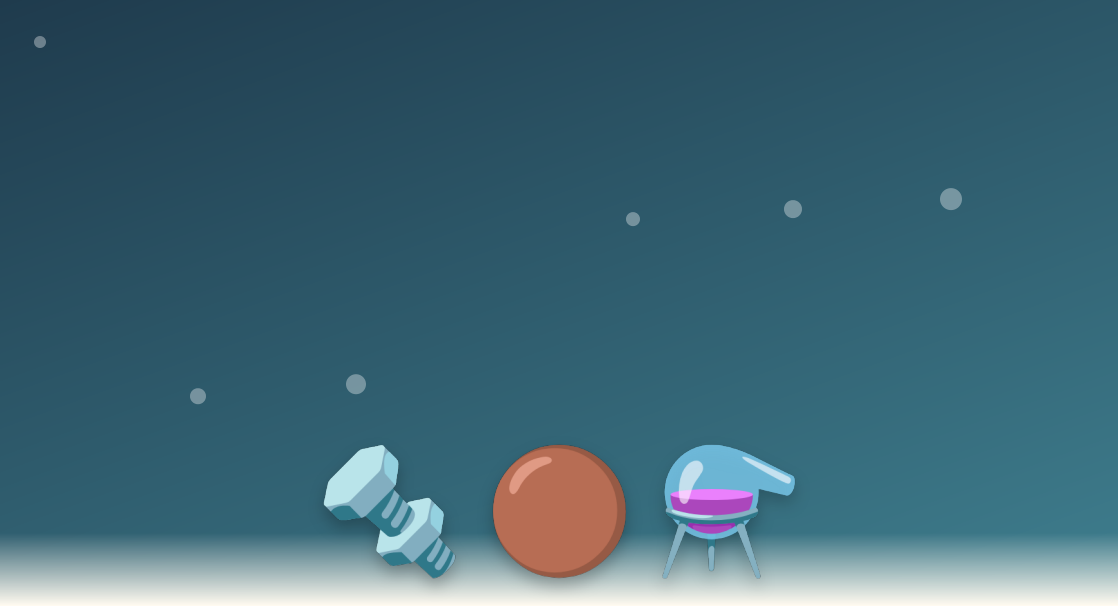
Natural methods have no side-effects but a high chance of failure.



The Barriers

Barrier methods stop sperm and ovum from meeting. **Condoms** for men and women also protect against STIs and AIDS. Diaphragms, cervical caps and vaults are barriers placed in the female body.

> 💡 **REMEMBER**
> **Condoms are the most widely used barrier method.**



The IUD Family

Intra-uterine devices are placed in the uterus by doctors. The Lippes loop releases nothing; **Copper-T** and Multiload 375 release copper ions that slow down sperms; **LNG-20** and Progestasert release hormones that make the uterus unsuitable for implantation.

💡 **REMEMBER**

IUDs are ideal for spacing children.



Pills and Saheli

Oral pills stop ovulation and implantation. **Saheli**, developed at CDRI Lucknow, is non-steroidal and taken just once a week. Emergency pills or IUDs work within 72 hours. Permanent methods are **vasectomy** in men and **tubectomy** in women.

💡 **REMEMBER**

Saheli — once a week, very few side-effects, high contraceptive value.

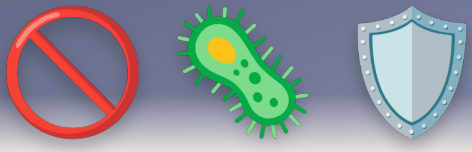


MTP — With Care

MTP, the medical termination of pregnancy, was legalised in India in 1971 and amended in 2017. It is safest in the **first trimester**, up to 12 weeks. Misusing tests to find a baby's sex and end pregnancies of girls is a crime.

💡 REMEMBER

Nearly 45 to 50 million MTPs are performed in a year all over the world.

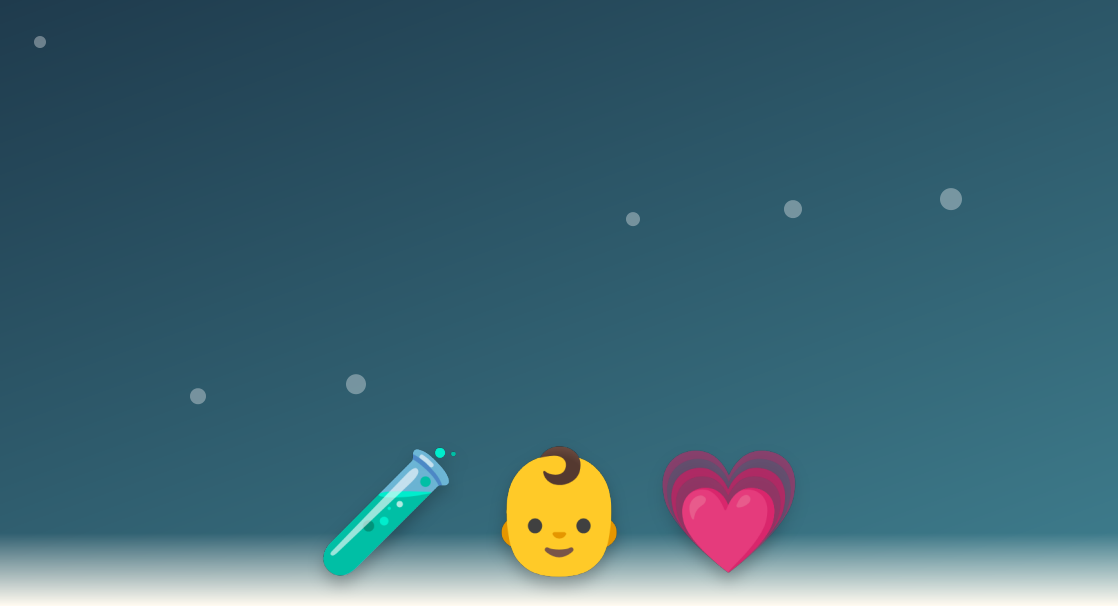


Staying Safe from STIs

Sexually transmitted infections include gonorrhoea, syphilis, genital herpes, chlamydiasis, genital warts, trichomoniasis, hepatitis B and HIV. Hepatitis B, genital herpes and HIV are not completely curable. Young people aged 15–24 are most at risk, so awareness and early treatment matter.

💡 **REMEMBER**

Prevention: avoid unknown partners, always use condoms, consult a doctor early.



Helping Couples

Couples who cannot have children can be helped by **ART**. In **IVF**, fertilisation happens in the lab (test-tube baby). The embryo is placed in the fallopian tube in **ZIFT** (up to 8 cells) or the uterus in **IUT** (more than 8 cells). **GIFT**, **ICSI** and **artificial insemination** are other methods.

💡 **REMEMBER**

ICSI: the sperm is injected directly into the ovum.



KEY TERMS

Words you met in this story

Tap a word to jump to its page. Can you explain each one?

reproductive health p.1 · RCH p.1 · Periodic abstinence p.2 · Lactational amenorrhea p.2 · Barrier methods p.3 · Condoms p.3 · Intra-uterine devices p.4 · Copper-T p.4 · LNG-20 p.4 · Saheli p.5 · vasectomy p.5 · tubectomy p.5 · MTP p.6 · first trimester p.6 · Sexually transmitted infections p.7 · ART p.8 · IVF p.8 · ZIFT p.8 · IUT p.8 · GIFT p.8 · ICSI p.8 · artificial insemination p.8



QUICK QUIZ

Do you remember?

1. Saheli was developed at:

- AIIMS
- CDRI Lucknow
- IARI
- ICMR

2. Copper-T works by:

- Releasing hormones
- Reducing sperm motility
- Blocking ovulation only
- Killing the ovum

3. MTP is safest during the:

- First trimester
- Second trimester
- Third trimester
- Ninth month

4. Which STI is NOT completely curable?

- Gonorrhoea
- Syphilis
- Genital herpes
- Chlamydiasis

5. In ZIFT the embryo (up to 8 cells) is placed in the:

- Uterus
- Fallopian tube
- Ovary
- Cervix

Answers: 1-CDRI Lucknow · 2-Reducing sperm motility · 3-First trimester · 4-Genital herpes · 5-Fallopian tube